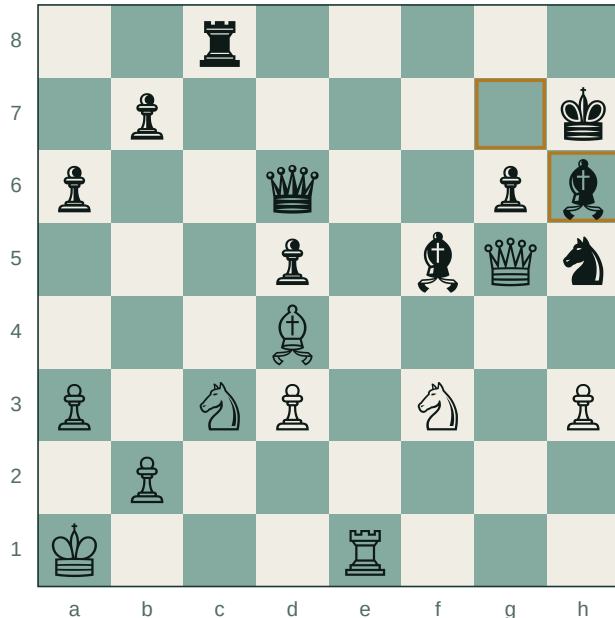


Deflection tactics: White, move 34

Deflection tactics

White to move



Previous move: 33...Bh6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

34. Re7+ Kg8 35. Qxh6

34.Re7+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **34...Kg8**.

35.Qxh6 The queen captures the bishop on h6.

At the end, nominal material is White 27 / Black 24 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from +0 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on h7. Geometrically undefended: queen on d6. Check for tactical protection.